

Leader

of the lead-free world

Company databases and contact management

A local workspace for researching companies and leads, managing contacts, and tracking follow-up - for business development, sales, partnerships, or job searching.

Keep company research, people, discussions and follow-up together. Work with separate databases and retain your records on your own computer.

English user manual

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Concept and Product: Benjamin Pinkas

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Click a contents entry to go to the section. This PDF is bundled with Leader and opens from About without an online viewer.

A workspace for company relationships

Leader turns a database of companies into a practical workspace for relationships and follow-up. Keep the people you know, what you have discussed and what to do next beside each company, so useful context is easy to find when you need it.

Use it for business development and sales, partnerships, supplier research or a personal job search. For BD and sales, it helps you track qualification, evaluation and production conversations. For a job search, it keeps employers, recruiters, discussions and next steps together. The interface uses commercial labels, but the underlying company cards and contacts support many kinds of company research and relationship management.

Your records stay on your computer. Company cards, multiple contacts, dated discussion history, tags, geography and next steps provide the working context; lists, Stage and Priority help you decide where to focus.

Open **About Leader > Open user manual (PDF)** for this bundled English guide. It opens from the local server and does not need an online document viewer.

About shows the application version, **Concept and Product: Benjamin Pinkas**, and a large random game piece on each opening.

Install and open Leader

You need Git, Node.js 24 or newer, pnpm matching `package.json`, and a modern browser. Repository access is needed to clone this private project. Dependencies are installed once; normal use then runs locally.

```
git clone https://github.com/Ben-Pin/Leader.git
cd Leader
pnpm install --frozen-lockfile
pnpm build
pnpm start
```

Open **`http://127.0.0.1:4177/`** on the computer running Leader. Keep the terminal open; Ctrl+C stops that foreground server. On Windows, `start-leader.cmd` can start the built application in the background and open the browser. Closing that browser tab does not stop a background server.

Windows has been tested. Linux/ARM64 and macOS are intended to use the same Node/browser workflow, but this release has no physical-machine verification for those platforms. The Windows `.cmd` launcher is optional and is not used on Linux.

A new checkout contains a fictional woodland Demo: animal-run companies buying nuts, vegetables and fruit. Examples use reserved `.example` email addresses. It does not download your customer database from GitHub. Select a database in **Connected company** in the sidebar, or use **Company databases** to create/import one.

Find your way around

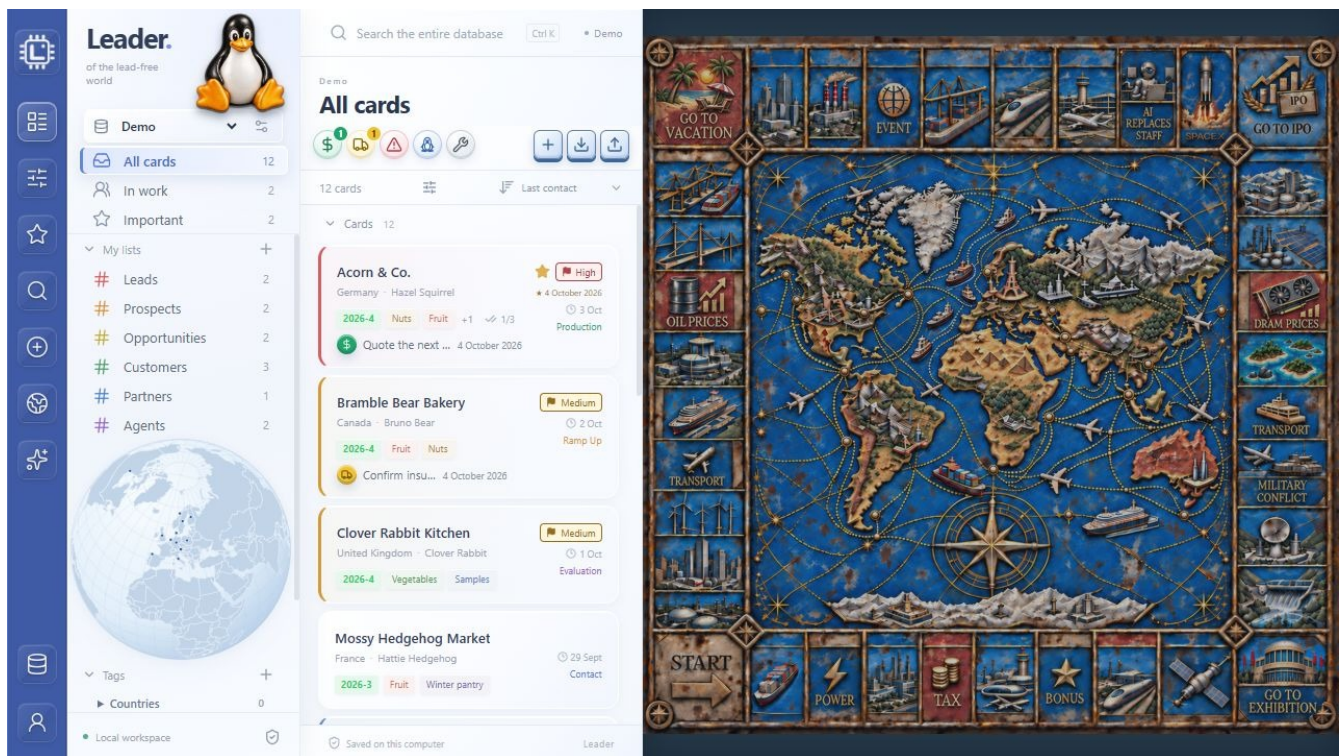


Figure 1. Woodland Demo: six account lists, company cards and the background map. All companies and contacts are fictional.

The blue rail opens All cards, In work, Important, Search, New card, the expanded globe, Auto-tag, Company databases and User settings. Hover an icon to read its label. On narrow screens, **Lists and tags** opens the sidebar.

The sidebar holds the company selector, lists, grouped tags and globe. The central column shows cards and Add card, List import and List export. Selecting a card opens its details on the right; the tabs are **Card > Contacts > History**.

All cards includes every non-archived card in the selected database. **In work** means at least one attention flag is active. **Important** shows starred cards. These are views, not extra copies of cards.

Lists, Stage and Priority

The permanent lists describe the account relationship:

List	Suggested use	Color
Leads	New, minimally qualified accounts	Red
Prospects	Potential customers; relationship not yet confirmed	Orange
Opportunities	Accounts with an identified commercial opportunity	Yellow
Customers	Confirmed buying customers	Green
Partners	Companies collaborating with you	Blue
Agents	Resellers/distributors supplying other companies	Violet

Choose **Card list** or **Account type** to move a card. Account type and its corresponding permanent list stay aligned. Each saved move records the date and source/destination in History, including intermediate draft moves. This is not automatic qualification: a forecast or a price request alone does not prove a purchase.

All six permanent lists are protected from deletion. Hide selected lists under **User settings > Visible permanent lists**; hiding does not remove records. Custom lists can be created, and empty custom lists can be deleted using **Delete list**. Move their cards elsewhere first.

Stage is independent of the list: **Contact > Evaluation > Ramp Up > Production > Legacy**. Choose the negotiation/project step in Card. Changing Stage does not move the card.

Priority is No priority, Low, Medium or High. A set priority appears beside the star with a colored left accent. Open **Filter cards** for Stage/Priority filters, or choose **Priority: high first** in sorting. Star is a separate Important marker. Stage remains beneath the contact date on a card row.

Create, edit, save and undo

Customers

Acorn & Co.

2026-4 × Nuts × Fruit × Winter pantry × +

Card Contacts 3 History 2

Country Germany Second country Optional

Stage Production Priority High

Last contact 03/10/2026 Next step 08/10/2026

Relationships Customer

Agents / partners

No partner linked

+ Link agent / partner

About customer

Fictional demo company. Squirrel-run woodland pantry. Ordered 120 kg of hazelnuts and 60 kg of walnuts for autumn deliveries. Requests dry, shell-on nuts in reusable 5 kg sacks. A 20 kg apple trial is under evaluation; the next quotation should price nuts and fruit separately.

Figure 2. Acorn & Co.: list, Stage, Priority and contact dates belong to the company card.

1. Select a company database and click **Add card** or **New card**.
2. Enter **Company or name**, a list, and any known country/contact date. Use a readable company name rather than its domain.
3. Click **Create card**, then fill the Card, Contacts and History tabs as needed.

Card fields include primary/second country, Stage, Priority, Last contact, Next step date, About customer, partner links and a Next steps checklist. Enter a second country only when it is meaningful for the account; the globe counts each distinct country.

Draft card fields save when you close or leave the card, switch company, or the browser window loses focus/becomes hidden. **Ctrl+S** (Cmd+S on macOS) saves explicitly. Wait for **All changes saved** in the footer before stopping the server. A save error remains visible and preserves the draft.

Undo discards the current unsaved card edits and closes the card. It does not roll back edits already saved through focus loss, an earlier save, or **Add note**. An unsubmitted note is not a saved History entry. Browser-tab closing may show the browser's native unsaved-change warning; do not rely on forced tab/process closure to finish a save.

If another window or MCP operation changes the same card, Leader rejects the stale revision. Copy your intended changes, refresh/read the latest card and reconcile them rather than overwriting it blindly.

Contacts and discussion history

Customers

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Card **Contacts 3** History 2

Name	Position	Email	Status
Hazel Squirrel	Purchasing manager	hazel@acorn.example	main
Pip Squirrel	Storekeeper	pip@acorn.example	active
Willow Squirrel	Position / role	willow@acorn.example	useful

+ Add contact

Figure 3. Each contact has a name, position, email and status. Willow's unknown position stays blank.

Open **Contacts** and add one row per contact: **Name, Position, Email, Status**. Up to 100 contacts are supported. Use a valid email when known; unknown fields may stay blank. **Position/Role stays empty unless the role is known**. Empty rows are omitted on save.

Status	Meaning
active	Default current contact
main	Primary point of contact
inactive	No longer active / left the company
disturbing	Contact requiring special handling
useful	Helpful contact
decisions	Decision-making contact

Customers ▾

Acorn & Co.

2026-4 × Nuts × Fruit × Winter pantry × +

Card Contacts 3 **History 2**

Discussion context, agreements, flag changes, and list transitions.

- 3 October 2026 - 13:30

Hazel confirmed the autumn nut order: 120 kg hazelnuts and 60 kg walnuts. Quoted reusable sacks; Thursday delivery is preferred.

Hazel Squirrel
- 24 September 2026 - 12:15

Pip received the apple samples. Keep the fruit trial separate from the confirmed nut order.

Hazel Squirrel Pip Squirrel

Figure 4. History keeps the conversation date and participating contacts beside each note.

In **History**, select at least one contact, write what was discussed and click **Add note**. This saves pending card edits first and then immediately records the note. Notes keep participant snapshots, so later removal or editing of a contact does not erase attribution. Older imported history can appear as **Older entry without contacts**. System flag/list events do not require participants.

Keep **About customer** as a concise factual summary of requirements, constraints and agreements. Keep dated conversations in History. For historical correspondence, include its actual date in the text: a newly added note has today's creation timestamp. Adding a note does not itself change Last contact; set that date explicitly when needed.

The five attention flags

The round controls in the card header are independent:

Color / symbol	Flag	Use
Green / dollar	In quote	Pricing response or quotation follow-up
Yellow / truck	Logistics issue	Delivery, stock or shipment concern
Red / warning	Administrative issue	Paperwork, payment or account issue
Blue / Tux	SW issue	Software problem
Gray / wrench	HW issue	Hardware problem

Click to turn a flag on or off. In the UI, either action sets **Last contact** to today's local date. Active flags expose a single-line comment of up to 300 characters. Save records each transition with its date and comment, including a later disable event. Clearing a flag hides and preserves its comment. Undo discards unsaved transitions. A comment edit without a toggle does not create a new on/off event.

The matching central-column controls select a flag view; their badges count matching accounts across the company database. Several flags can be active on one card.

Search, tags and the globe

Ctrl+K (Cmd+K) focuses Search. Text search covers the whole selected company database, including company/card names, countries, contact names/roles/emails, About customer, flag comments and custom tag names. It overrides the selected sidebar list/tag/flag view; Stage and Priority filters still apply. Clear Search to return to the sidebar selection. History-note text and checklist text are not part of this search.

Custom tags are grouped into **Countries, Time, Product, Stage, Application, Other**. Choose Group when creating a tag. To move an existing tag, select it in the sidebar and change **Tag group** above the result list. **Delete tag** removes the tag and its assignments without deleting cards.

Contact-quarter tags are automatic, appear first, and use YYYY-Q, for example **2027-1**. Set Last contact and click **Auto-tag quarters from last contact dates** to synchronize dated cards across the selected database. Future quarters are derived automatically; you do not need to create them. A card with no exact date is not assigned an invented day. Removing its quarter badge clears the draft contact date and fallback quarter.

The globe follows the current result, including search and Stage/Priority filters, across every result page. Click a country marker to open its matching directory. Country dots are spread within the country for readability; they are not verified office coordinates. Missing/unrecognized countries are not plotted. Drag to rotate; card/country selection rotates smoothly. Reduced-motion browser preferences reduce animation.

List import and export

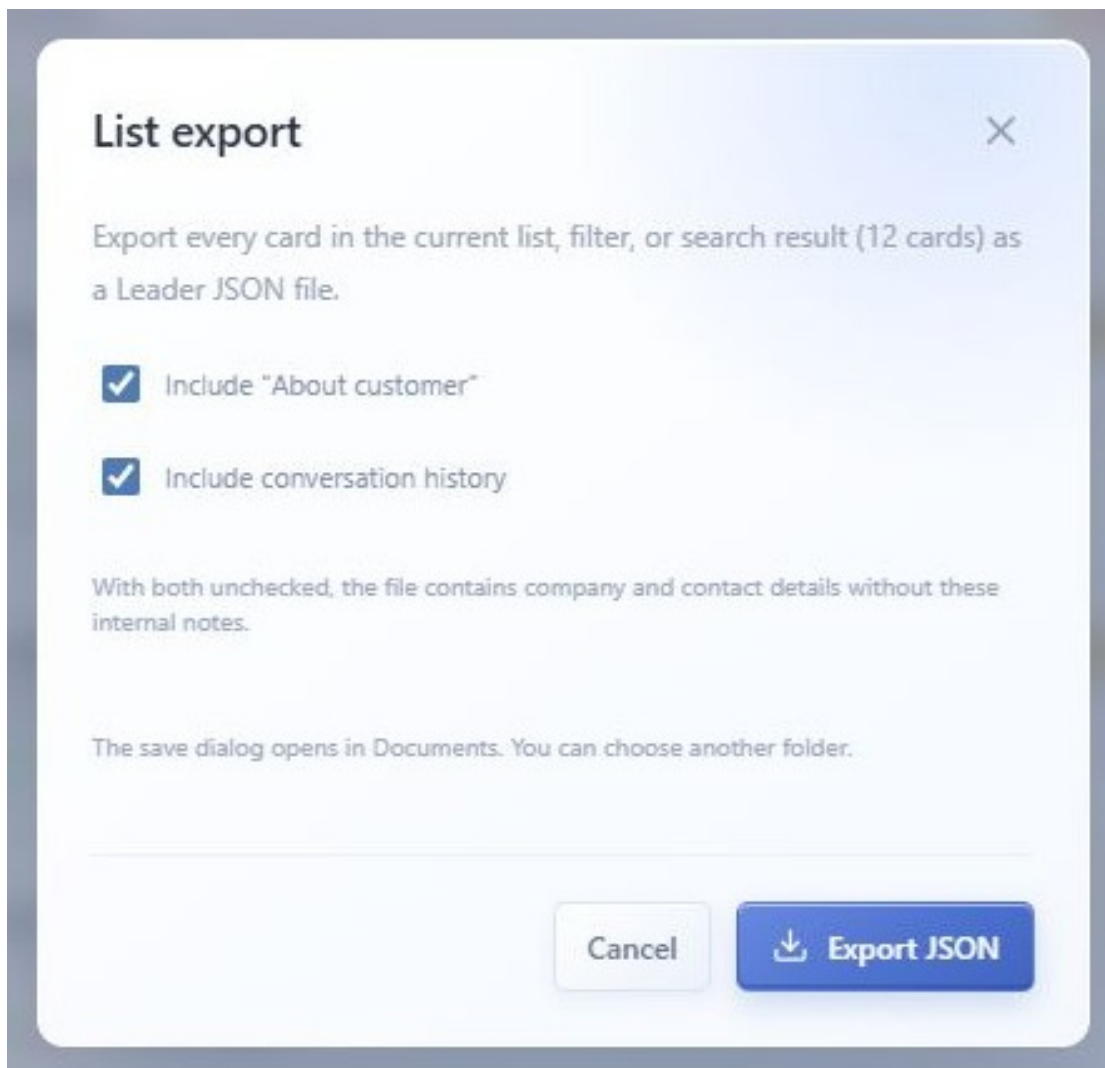


Figure 5. Choose whether a list export includes About customer and conversation history.

The central-column **down arrow** is **List import**; the **up arrow** is **List export**. List transfers use Leader list JSON, not CSV, PST or a full company snapshot.

For export, select the desired list/view or search and filters, then click List export. Every matching page is included, not only the currently loaded rows. Independently choose whether to include **About customer** and **conversation history**; both are on by default. Excluding them clears those sections in the exported copy only. Current flags, their comments and structured company/contact fields are still included.

Compatible browsers ask where to save and initially suggest Documents. Other browsers use their configured download destination; enable their “ask where to save” setting if needed. The list filename ends in local ddmh-hhmm, for example 041018-1823 on 4 October at 18:23. Full company exports use the normal browser download flow instead.

For import, choose a Leader list JSON file and a mode:

- **Use each card's category:** route it to the corresponding permanent list.
- **Set every card's category from one target list:** choose the destination and update the imported category to match.

Existing card IDs are skipped, not updated or merged. Equal names with different IDs can still create duplicates. New imported cards show **Imported** until their first saved edit. Valid available agent links are restored; unavailable links are reported as omitted. A failed validation rolls back the list import.

Company databases, agents and partners

Company databases creates an empty database, exports the selected database, or imports a complete **Leader company JSON** into a new separate database. Use a new company name when one already exists; imports do not replace existing data.

Removing a database from the connected list preserves its files. Open **Disconnected databases > Reconnect** to bring it back. The last connected database cannot be disconnected.

On Card, **+ Link agent / partner** searches existing partner/agent cards in the same database. Select the relationship; linked accounts appear in the partner's **Clients** section. Unlink removes the relationship only. Self-links and cycles are rejected. Cards with linked clients must have those links removed before changing to a non-partner category.

User settings and game pieces

Open **User settings** at the bottom of the blue rail. Change the display name, **Leader's motto**, visible lists and background map, then click **Save settings**. The default motto is **of the lead-free world**. The profile name is a local preference, not a login.

The background appears only while no card is open. Choose the built-in map, disable it, or load a square **PNG/JPEG/WebP** up to **20 MB** and **8192 x 8192** pixels. Its 1:1 ratio is preserved; it displays at 70% opacity (30% transparent).

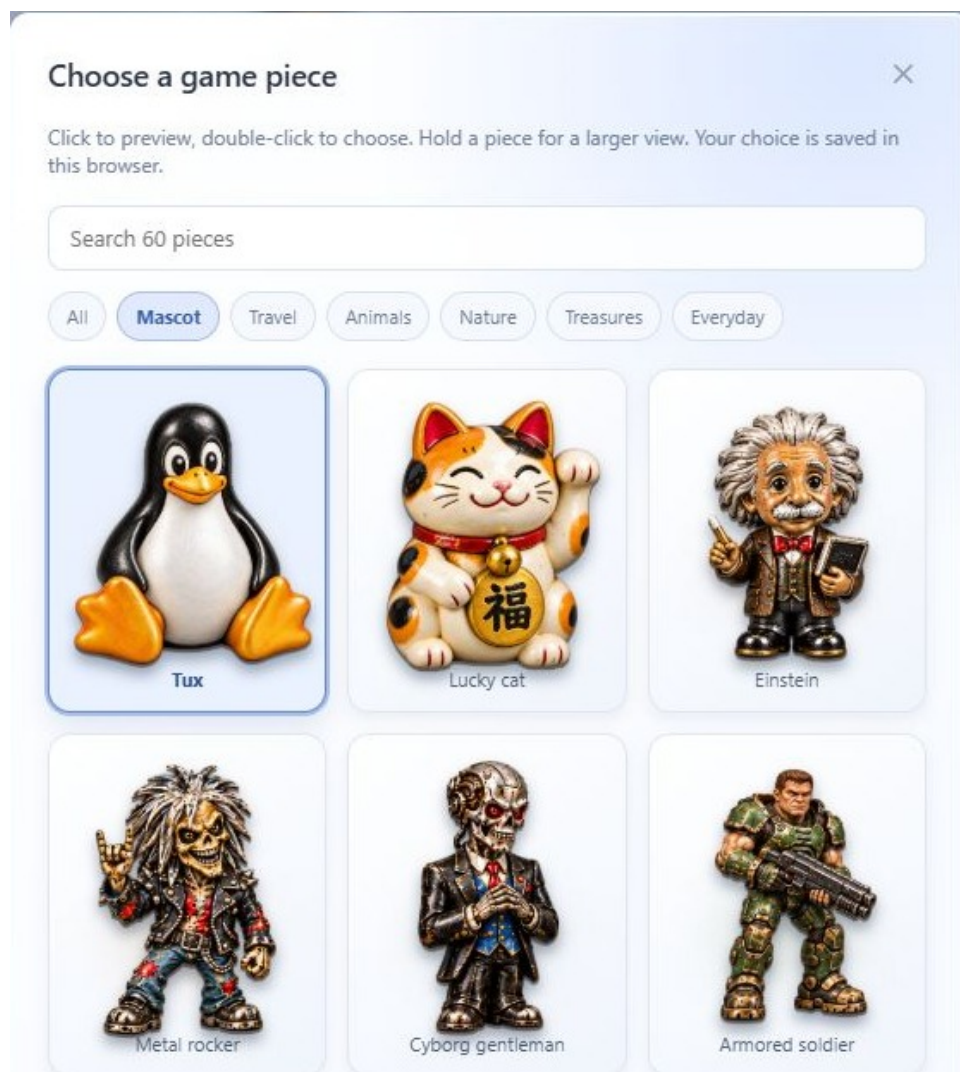


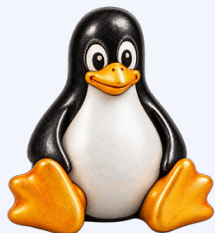
Figure 6. The game-piece gallery opens in Mascot; preview a piece, then double-click or use the selection button.

Click the selected figurine beside Leader to open the gallery of 60 finished pieces. It starts in **Mascot**; use categories/search to find others. Click to preview; double-click or **Use this piece** to select. Holding a figure for about 350 ms enlarges it in place with a slight slow wobble; release returns it to position.

Appearance preferences and the selected piece are stored in this browser profile; custom maps use browser storage. Company JSON backups do not contain these settings.

Game piece personalities

A playful companion for the workspace. These invented strengths and lucky associations are stories; selecting a piece does not change records, priorities or results.

**Tux**

Strength: Calm troubleshooting and practical teamwork.

Lucky for: A stubborn problem finally making sense.

**Race car**

Strength: Fast decisions without losing focus.

Lucky for: A clear road to the next milestone.

**Propeller plane**

Strength: Seeing beyond the nearest obstacle.

Lucky for: An introduction across borders.

**Tugboat**

Strength: Helping a heavy project move steadily.

Lucky for: A difficult handover reaching safe harbour.

**Steam train**

Strength: Dependable routines and steady progress.

Lucky for: A delivery arriving exactly when needed.

**Lucky cat**

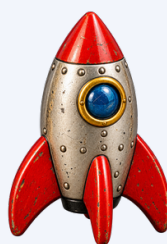
Strength: Welcoming people and spotting opportunities.

Lucky for: A friendly new customer walking through the door.

**Puppy**

Strength: Loyal follow-up and warm relationships.

Lucky for: An old contact returning with good news.

**Rocket**

Strength: Bold launches and ambitious experiments.

Lucky for: The first successful lift-off of a new project.

**Globe**

Strength: Connecting distant people and markets.

Lucky for: A promising route into a new country.

**Treasure chest**

Strength: Recognising value hidden in plain sight.

Lucky for: An unexpectedly useful discovery.

**Rabbit**

Strength: Quick learning and nimble adjustments.

Lucky for: A small trial growing into a healthy opportunity.

**Lion**

Strength: Courage in demanding conversations.

Lucky for: The confidence to ask the important question.

**Hippo**

Strength: Patience and a stable negotiating position.

Lucky for: A large agreement finding firm ground.

**Parrot**

Strength: Clear messages and memorable storytelling.

Lucky for: The right words reaching the right listener.

**Pelican**

Strength: Gathering useful resources for the team.

Lucky for: A well-stocked plan with nothing essential missing.

**Double-decker bus**

Strength: Bringing many people along together.

Lucky for: All stakeholders arriving at the same conclusion.

**Apple**

Strength: Simple, fresh ideas and everyday care.

Lucky for: A productive morning and a healthy new start.

**Pineapple**

Strength: Hospitality with a distinctive personality.

Lucky for: A warm welcome in an unfamiliar market.

**Sheep**

Strength: Gentle consistency and cooperative work.

Lucky for: A group finding an easy rhythm together.

**Einstein**

Strength: Curiosity, questions and clever connections.

Lucky for: An elegant answer to an awkward puzzle.

**Hiking boot**

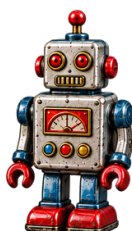
Strength: Persistence through difficult terrain.

Lucky for: A long search ending at the right company.

**Vintage camera**

Strength: Noticing details others overlook.

Lucky for: A useful fact captured before it is forgotten.

**Tin robot**

Strength: Orderly work and reliable checklists.

Lucky for: A repetitive task becoming pleasantly manageable.

**Typewriter**

Strength: Precise notes and carefully chosen words.

Lucky for: A proposal expressing exactly what you mean.

**Rotary telephone**

Strength: Starting conversations and listening well.

Lucky for: A timely call opening the next door.

**Chess knight**

Strength: Creative moves and tactical patience.

Lucky for: An unexpected route around a familiar obstacle.

**Owl**

Strength: Thoughtful judgement after careful observation.

Lucky for: A sound decision made without rushing.

**Flowering cactus**

Strength: Resilience and sensible boundaries.

Lucky for: A difficult season ending with a bright bloom.

**Spyglass telescope**

Strength: Long-range planning and focused research.

Lucky for: A distant possibility becoming visible.

**Hot-air balloon**

Strength: Perspective and a lighter approach.

Lucky for: A fresh view of a complicated situation.

**Metal rocker**

Strength: Energy, individuality and fearless expression.

Lucky for: A memorable pitch that wakes up the room.

**Cyborg gentleman**

Strength: Combining courtesy with analytical precision.

Lucky for: A technical discussion becoming a trusted relationship.

**Pastel unicorn**

Strength: Imagination and optimistic experiments.

Lucky for: A surprising idea finding its first supporter.

**Lemur**

Strength: Playful curiosity and social agility.

Lucky for: An informal chat turning into a useful connection.

**Astronaut helmet**

Strength: Preparation before entering unfamiliar territory.

Lucky for: A safe first step into a challenging assignment.

**Red octopus**

Strength: Coordinating several threads without losing context.

Lucky for: Many loose ends coming together at once.

**Raven**

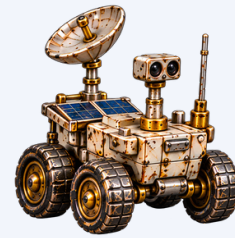
Strength: Resourceful thinking and sharp recall.

Lucky for: A forgotten clue unlocking the current problem.

**Arcade cabinet**

Strength: Learning through attempts and celebrating progress.

Lucky for: A second try beating the previous high score.

**Mars rover**

Strength: Methodical exploration of untested ground.

Lucky for: A small piece of evidence proving a new direction.

**Armored soldier**

Strength: Protecting commitments and holding a steady line.

Lucky for: A hard deadline met despite obstacles.

**Ornate seahorse**

Strength: Balance, adaptability and quiet distinction.

Lucky for: An unusual niche becoming a good fit.

**Royal crown**

Strength: Responsible leadership and setting standards.

Lucky for: A team placing confidence in your judgement.

**Diving helmet**

Strength: Looking below the surface of an issue.

Lucky for: The real requirement emerging from a deep discussion.

**Armillary sphere**

Strength: Finding patterns in moving parts.

Lucky for: A complicated plan settling into alignment.

**Lighthouse**

Strength: Clear direction and dependable guidance.

Lucky for: A lost conversation finding its way back.



Violin and bow

Strength: Harmony, timing and attentive collaboration.

Lucky for: Several strong opinions forming one workable agreement.



Hourglass

Strength: Patient pacing and respect for timing.

Lucky for: An opportunity ripening at the right moment.



Explorer's map

Strength: Turning uncertainty into a useful route.

Lucky for: A promising path through unfamiliar companies.



Dragon

Strength: Ambition, conviction and guarding valuable work.

Lucky for: A bold negotiation protecting the value of your offer.



Gramophone

Strength: Listening to experience and preserving good stories.

Lucky for: An older relationship sharing a valuable lesson.



Samurai fox

Strength: Disciplined strategy with a clever flourish.

Lucky for: A precise move at the decisive moment.



Mechanical bee

Strength: Diligent teamwork and small repeated efforts.

Lucky for: Many little follow-ups producing a fruitful result.



Eggplant

Strength: Original thinking and a cheerful sense of humour.

Lucky for: An unconventional idea getting a fair hearing.



Blue whale

Strength: Depth, calm and confidence over long distances.

Lucky for: A major relationship growing steadily rather than hurriedly.

**Bamboo panda**

Strength: Finding balance and lowering the temperature.

Lucky for: A tense discussion becoming comfortable again.

**Mail truck**

Strength: Reliable delivery and keeping promises visible.

Lucky for: An awaited reply arriving in your inbox.

**Traveling snail**

Strength: Patient travel with everything needed close at hand.

Lucky for: Slow progress reaching a lasting destination.

**Frog king**

Strength: Seeing potential before appearances improve.

Lucky for: An overlooked lead turning into a rewarding relationship.

**Vintage radio**

Strength: Listening for useful signals in the noise.

Lucky for: A timely message tuning you into an opportunity.

**Wise tortoise**

Strength: Long memory and sustainable progress.

Lucky for: A careful decision paying off over time.

Move to another computer and recover data

1. In the old installation, choose the company and **Company databases > Export**. Wait for the file to finish downloading.
2. Install/build/start Leader on the new computer and open <http://127.0.0.1:4177/> there.
3. Choose **Company databases > Connect from Leader JSON file**, select the export, check the company name, then **Import and connect**.
4. Switch to the imported company and verify cards, contacts and History. Repeat for other companies.

For an exact filesystem transfer of the registry and every database, stop Leader and any MCP processes using those files on both computers, then copy the entire **data/** directory into the new checkout before restarting. Never copy a live SQLite database/WAL pair as an ordinary file backup. Browser settings/custom maps must be configured again in the new browser profile.

The standard multi-company server makes verified JSON snapshots at startup and every six hours while running, retaining the newest 28 per connected company under **data/backups/<company-id>/**. Copy important snapshots to another disk. Automatic snapshots are not produced while the app is stopped or in explicit single-database mode.

To recover a snapshot, use **Connect from Leader JSON file** and import it under a new company name. Inspect it before switching to the recovered copy. Git clone alone restores code/artwork, not customer data. External assistant mail analysis is separate from Leader's built-in JSON importer.

Update and troubleshoot

The release baseline is **1.0.0**. New or changed functionality advances the minor version (for example, 1.1.0); fixes and documentation-only releases advance the patch version. Breaking compatibility changes advance the major version.

Before updating, save drafts and export important databases. Stop Leader and any MCP process using the checkout, then run:

```
git pull --ff-only
pnpm install --frozen-lockfile
pnpm build
pnpm start
```

Problem	What to check
Browser cannot connect	Start the server; use the printed address on the same computer
Port 4177 is occupied	Stop the earlier instance; a second server cannot use the same port
Server runs but the UI is missing	Run <code>pnpm build</code> before <code>pnpm start</code>
Session expired after restart	Reload once the previous draft is saved or copied
A card seems missing	Check the company, clear search/filters, show hidden lists; archived cards need restoration by ID through MCP/API
External MCP changes are not visible	Refresh the browser after saving the current draft; there is no live push
Cannot add a note	Add a contact and select at least one participant
Cannot delete a list	Permanent lists are protected; custom lists must be empty
Cannot change a tag group	Select a custom tag; derived contact quarters have no editable group
Export does not ask for a folder	Browser lacks the save-picker API; configure its download settings
Import rejects a file	Match list JSON with List import, or company JSON with Company databases
Launcher fails on Windows	Check <code>data/server.log</code> and that dependencies/build are present

Leader currently has no in-app archive browser/restore control, scheduled reminders, attachment storage, outgoing email or cloud synchronization. Use the [MCP connector](#) for supported assistant operations; installing that connector is separate from opening Leader in a browser.